AI Growth Strategy for Bennett Wealth Partners

The Vcrsoft Way: Understand → Diagnose → Identify AI solutions → Prioritize → Deliver. Business Snapshot is step 1, Growth Diagnosis is step 2, Opportunities are step 3, Prioritized Top 3 is step 4, and the Executive Summary, 30-Day Plan, Risks & Metrics are step 5.

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Executive Summary

Bennett Wealth Partners is an independent, fee-only fiduciary SEC-registered investment adviser managing approximately $650 million across 520 households with $4.6 million in annual revenue, operating with a 10-person team including founder Michael Bennett, three advisors, three client service associates, operations manager Karen Doyle, compliance officer Rachel Torres, and one admin. The firm's primary 12-month growth goals are to reach $5.2 to $5.3 million in revenue, expand AUM to $730 million, and increase profit to $1.15 million while limiting hiring to at most one or two new hires. The central operational bottleneck is that advisors and associates spend 1,500 annual hours preparing for 600 review meetings while managing 25 weekly inbound communications each, alongside unmanaged front-end leakage where about 30% of discovery meetings go cold without systematic follow-up. Following the owner's explicit governance precondition and prioritized order, the firm will implement an approved AI framework for Microsoft Copilot drafting, establish automated Wealthbox pipeline follow-up and onboarding tracking, and streamline review preparation using existing Orion and eMoney licenses.

Business Snapshot

Bennett Wealth Partners is an independent, fee-only fiduciary RIA registered with the SEC, with no broker-dealer affiliation and no commissions. The firm serves about 520 households representing approximately $650 million under management, with typical client household assets in the $1 to $5 million range. The team consists of 10 people: founder and CEO Michael Bennett, three advisors (Sarah Chen, David Okafor, and Emily Ross), three client service associates, operations manager Karen Doyle, compliance officer Rachel Torres, and one admin. Annual revenue is about $4.6 million, with roughly 94% coming from advisory fees ($4.32 million), about $180k in standalone planning fees, and about $100k in 401(k) consulting and other work. The advisory fee schedule is approximately 0.85% on the first $1 million, 0.65% on the next $4 million, and 0.50% above $5 million, with an average advisory fee of around 0.70%.

New clients arrive primarily via referrals (65% total, split into 45% existing clients and 20% centers of influence like CPAs and attorneys), with the website contributing about 10% and miscellaneous channels making up the rest. The top 20% of households generate about 55% of firm revenue, representing the firm's primary profitability lever for future differentiated service tiering.

Growth Aspiration

Michael Bennett's 12-month goals are to grow revenue by 10 to 15 percent to about $5.2 to $5.3 million, increase AUM from $650 million to about $730 million, and raise profit from roughly $900,000 to about $1.15 million. This must be achieved without hiring at the same rate, capping headcount additions at at most one or two new hires, while increasing firm value and reducing day-to-day dependence on the founder (who currently works about 50 hours a week and targets 40). Operating parameters for improvements include an operating budget of $4,000 to $6,000 per month, a one-time setup budget of up to $15,000, a payback expectation of 9 to 12 months, and Karen dedicating eight hours a week as implementation owner under a strict pilot requirement. The report notes the $650 million to $730 million AUM target ($80 million gap over 12 months), which is supported by approximately $35 million a year in net new assets, plus market appreciation and recovered prospects.

Growth Diagnosis

The clearest evidence-based explanation for what constrains growth at Bennett Wealth Partners is that advisory and associate capacity is completely consumed by administrative and review preparation obligations—specifically 1,500 annual hours dedicated to 600 annual review meetings and handling high volumes of routine inbound communications—leaving no usable time to absorb additional client households without headcount expansion. This internal capacity bottleneck is compounded on the front end by unmanaged leakage, where approximately 30% of discovery meetings go cold without systematic follow-up beyond one or two emails. Furthermore, growth cannot be accelerated through unvetted software or AI tools because the firm lacks an approved AI policy, vendor list, or logging framework, while severe key-person dependency rests on Karen in operations (11 years) and Rachel in compliance (5 years) without documented step-by-step operating procedures or cross-training. Transcript facts supporting this include: 600 review meetings taking 2.5 hours each (1,500 hours); 25 inbound emails or calls per advisor weekly (40% routine); 6 monthly discovery meetings with 30% going cold (about 20 households annually); and four-step duplicate manual data entry across Wealthbox, Orion, Schwab, and eMoney causing onboarding friction and a 15% stall rate

beyond 60 days. A plausible alternative hypothesis is that the fundamental constraint is not merely review preparation time, but rather the firm's lack of documented operating procedures and cross-training for Karen and Rachel, which creates a single point of failure that would cap operational throughput regardless of software or workflow optimizations. Key uncertainties include Rachel's exact compliance review timeline for tool approvals and whether Orion and eMoney feature sets required for single-pull review packets are fully included in existing licenses without add-on costs.

Sales & Growth Engine

The prospect journey begins with an initial inquiry (averaging 10 qualified inquiries per month), leading to a discovery meeting (averaging 6 held per month, with a discovery meeting-to-client conversion rate of about 38%). From there, the process moves to a proposal, agreement signing on DocuSign, Schwab account opening, asset transfer via ACATS taking 7 to 14 days, eMoney data gathering, and finally getting invested. The overall onboarding timeline takes 3 to 5 weeks from signed agreement to fully funded, and duplicates data entry across Wealthbox, Orion, Schwab forms, and eMoney. About 15% of onboarding prospects stall beyond 60 days or drop out, driven roughly two-thirds by client gathering delays and ACATS transfer times, and one-third by internal manual re-entry and a lack of systematic file tracking. On the front end, approximately 30% of discovery meetings go cold after the first meeting (representing roughly 1.8 prospects per month or about 20 households annually), and nobody currently owns systematic follow-up beyond one or two emails sent by advisors. New clients arrive primarily via referrals (65% total, split into 45% existing clients and 20% centers of influence like CPAs and attorneys), and centers of influence like CPAs and attorneys generate 20%, while the website contributes 10% and miscellaneous channels make up the rest. Monthly funnel performance averages 10 qualified inquiries, 6 discovery meetings held, and approximately 2.3 new clients gained per month at a 38% meeting-to-client conversion rate (totaling about 28 new client households per year). Client churn runs about 2.3% annually (roughly 12 households), driven mostly by death, relocation, divorce, or fee sensitivity, and the firm currently lacks proactive client satisfaction surveys or early-warning attrition metrics.

Current AI Use

The firm currently uses no dedicated AI tools, LLMs, or automated customer-facing agents, and has no approved AI policy, approved-vendor list, or logging framework in place. Microsoft Copilot is already bundled in existing licenses but is not yet approved or deployed for internal

drafting. Zoom AI Companion is used for meetings, but the owner is uncertain whether its summaries are being properly archived through Smarsh.

Opportunities

> **Establish a Practical and Defensible Framework for Using AI Safely in the Firm**
>
> **Problem:** The firm has no approved AI policy, approved-vendor list, or usage logging, preventing the adoption of time-saving AI drafting and automation tools due to SEC privacy rules, client confidentiality agreements, and Smarsh archiving requirements.
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> **Why it matters:** Serves as an essential governance precondition defined by the owner; without it, staff cannot legally or safely deploy Microsoft Copilot, workflow automation, or meeting summarization tools without creating severe regulatory and compliance exposure.
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> **AI approach:** Process/management improvement
>
> **How:** Compliance officer Rachel Torres conducts formal vendor reviews, data handling assessments, retention checks, and setup of usage logs for evaluating tools. The initial evaluation focuses on three priorities under identical testing criteria: Microsoft Copilot as an internal drafting tool for routine inquiry replies and meeting-prep summaries (always human-approved, no client financial data sent to public services), Wealthbox workflow automation, and Zoom AI Companion archival verification through Smarsh.
>
> **Impact:** Establishes a compliant operational foundation within 90 days, enabling secure internal adoption of Copilot and Wealthbox automation while ensuring zero client financial data enters public AI services.
>
> **Effort:** Requires Rachel Torres's compliance review, vendor due diligence questionnaires, Michael Bennett's final approval, and verification of Smarsh archiving integration.
>
> **Validation:** Rachel Torres confirms the written AI-use policy, approved-tool list, and usage logging mechanism are active and operational within 90 days.

Implement Systematic Post-Discovery Prospect Follow-Up Sequence

Problem: Approximately 30% of discovery meetings go cold after the first meeting (about 1.8 prospects per month or roughly 20 households annually), representing potential advisory fee value leaking out of the funnel because advisors send one or two emails and move on without systematic follow-up ownership.

Why it matters: Recovers high-intent prospective client households representing an average household of $1.25 million and a 0.70% advisory fee rate (worth $8,750 per year in annualized recurring fee value per cold prospect, or roughly $15,750 in monthly annualized cohort value across 1.8 monthly cold prospects), directly supporting the AUM and revenue growth goals without increasing advertising spend.

AI approach: Conventional automation

How: Utilize the existing Wealthbox CRM (paying about $18,000 annually) to establish a prospect pipeline with stages: new inquiry, discovery booked, discovery held, proposal sent, follow-up, nurture, and won or lost. Automation rules trigger when a discovery meeting is marked held with no next step booked: Wealthbox creates a follow-up task due in three business days assigned to a client service associate. If overdue, it escalates to operations manager Karen Doyle's oversight list. Subsequent tasks fire at one week and two weeks before moving the prospect to a light quarterly nurture. All outbound communications require advisor approval.

Impact: Illustrative value: Assuming 6 monthly discovery meetings, a 30% drop-off rate (about 1.8 prospects a month or roughly 20 a year), each worth about $8,750 a year in advisory fees, and a 38% recovery/conversion rate, recovering these prospects yields an estimated calculator-backed annualised recurring fee value (about 20 cold prospects annually, each worth about $8,750 in annualised recurring fee value, with a 38% recovery rate), representing annualised recurring fee value once funded rather than first-year revenue.

Effort: Requires Karen Doyle to configure Wealthbox pipeline stages and task rules, associate execution, and advisor approval guardrails; fits within existing operating budget and eight weekly implementation hours.

Validation: Karen Doyle tracks weekly in Wealthbox that 95% of inquiries receive a response within one business day and follow-up tasks execute on schedule.

Streamline Review Meeting Preparation Workflow

Problem: Advisors and associates spend about two and a half hours preparing for each of the firm's 600 annual review meetings, totaling 1,500 annual hours consumed by manual Orion report pulling (45 minutes per meeting), eMoney plan updates (40 minutes per meeting), agenda creation (30 minutes per meeting), and follow-up task setting (35 minutes per meeting), creating a severe capacity bottleneck.

Why it matters: Reclaims hundreds of advisor and associate hours currently lost to manual administrative data gathering, returning that capacity directly to business development, prospect follow-up, and complex client planning.

AI approach: Conventional automation

How: Karen Doyle tests whether pre-built review packet templates in Orion (performance, holdings, allocation, and billing in a single pull), eMoney planning summaries/snapshots, and standard agenda templates are included in existing license agreements or require add-ons. A strict three-step quality control process is instituted: Karen builds the packet, the advisor verifies every figure against Orion and eMoney using an initialed checklist, and final packets are saved in the client file. Unsigned packets do not go out.

Impact: Reduces review preparation time from two and a half hours down to under an hour and a half per meeting, freeing substantial team capacity across 600 annual reviews while maintaining zero increase in reconciliation errors.

Effort: Requires Karen Doyle's testing of Orion and eMoney feature sets, Rachel Torres's recordkeeping archival verification, advisor adherence to the verification checklist, and Michael Bennett's pilot approval.

Validation: Karen Doyle measures weekly prep duration from Wealthbox and Orion reports to confirm average preparation time drops below 90 minutes per meeting within the target timeframe.

Reduce Onboarding Stall Rate and Duplicate Data Entry

Problem: About 15% of onboarding prospects stall beyond 60 days or drop out, driven by client gathering delays, 7 to 14 day ACATS transfer windows, and internal slowness caused by re-entering prospect details four separate times across unintegrated Wealthbox, Orion, Schwab forms, and eMoney systems without systematic file tracking.

Why it matters: Eliminates redundant manual typing and catches stalled onboarding files before they drop out, accelerating the conversion of signed agreements into fully funded fee-paying accounts.

AI approach: Conventional automation

How: Karen Doyle introduces a simple onboarding pipeline in Wealthbox with stages for agreement signed, account opened, transfer in progress, and funded and invested, with a date on each stage and age in days. Karen runs a weekly report of files that have not moved in seven days to actively chase missing client documents or Schwab ACATS status. Rachel Torres defines compliance requirements for any future pre-population methods, including client review and verification of pre-filled fields, no changes after client attestation, audit trails, and proper archival.

Impact: Illustrative value: Assuming 10 monthly inquiries, a 15% monthly stall rate recovered over 12 months, average household AUM of $1,250,000, and a 0.70% advisory fee rate, recovering stalled onboarding files represents an estimated calculator-backed annualised recurring fee value (derived from 10 * 0.15 * 12 * (1,250,000 / 520) * 0.0070), representing annualised recurring fee value once funded.

Effort: Requires Wealthbox pipeline configuration by Karen Doyle, weekly chase habits, and Rachel Torres's compliance oversight.

Validation: Karen Doyle measures weekly that the median onboarding duration drops from 3 to 5 weeks down to under 3 weeks within 90 days.

Package Differentiated High-Touch Service Tiers for Top-Tier Households

Problem: The top 20% of households generate about 55% of firm revenue yet receive roughly the same service cadence as a $1 million household, with high-touch deliverables currently handled informally and ad hoc rather than as a structured service tier.

Why it matters: Protects revenue concentration by formalizing dedicated, premium service packaging for the firm's most valuable clients, improving retention and deepening wallet share among business owners and executives near retirement.

AI approach: Process/management improvement

How: Formalize service tiers by packaging distinct, high-touch deliverables for top-tier households—such as structured proactive year-end tax planning, scheduled estate attorney and CPA coordination, and defined semi-annual review packages—backed by internal tracking to monitor service hours and client engagement.

Impact: Strengthens client retention across the top 20% revenue segment, reducing the risk of fee sensitivity or unmanaged departures among accounts generating over half the firm's revenue.

Effort: Requires advisor alignment, definition of service-tier criteria, and operational tracking by Karen Doyle.

Validation: Not established in this interview.

Prioritized Top 3

> **#1 — Establish a Practical and Defensible Framework for Using AI Safely in the Firm**
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> **Why this rank:** The owner explicitly designated AI governance as a mandatory precondition and third priority that must precede other tool deployments, directly addressing the lack of approved policies or logging while satisfying risk and feasibility requirements.
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> **First step:** Rachel Torres reviews vendor terms, data handling, Smarsh archiving, and usage logging requirements for Microsoft Copilot, Wealthbox workflow, and Zoom AI Companion.
>
> **Value:** Medium: Establishes a secure compliance baseline enabling safe internal automation without exposing non-public personal information.
>
> **Feasibility:** High: Leverages existing compliance oversight and bundled Microsoft Copilot access under established SEC privacy rules.
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> **Cost:** Low: Operates within existing operating budget using bundled licenses and current staff time.
>
> **Risk:** Low: Mitigates regulatory and data breach exposure by prohibiting public AI tools like ChatGPT for client financial data.
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> **Time to benefit:** Weeks: Written AI policy, approved tool list, and usage log established within 30 to 90 days.

#2 — Implement Systematic Post-Discovery Prospect Follow-Up Sequence

Why this rank: Ranked first by the owner among operational priorities to stop front-end leakage of roughly 20 cold prospects annually, offering rapid value recovery with high feasibility.

First step: Karen Doyle configures the prospect pipeline and three-day follow-up task automation rules in Wealthbox.

Value: High: Recovers estimated recurring annualized fee value from a portion of the 20 annual cold prospects.

Feasibility: High: Uses existing Wealthbox CRM software without purchasing external tracking tools.

Cost: Low: Implemented using existing Wealthbox license ($18,000/year already paid) and associate time.

Risk: Low: Controlled by mandatory advisor approval on all outbound associate communications.

Time to benefit: Weeks: Pipeline configuration and task automation active within the first 30 days.

#3 — Streamline Review Meeting Preparation Workflow

Why this rank: Combined by the owner with onboarding under the second priority to eliminate the 1,500-hour review prep bottleneck constraining advisor capacity and growth targets.

First step: Karen Doyle tests pre-built review packet templates in Orion and eMoney planning snapshots to confirm license inclusion.

Value: High: Cuts review preparation time from 2.5 hours to under 1.5 hours across 600 annual reviews.

Feasibility: Medium: Depends on Karen confirming specific pre-built reporting features in existing Orion and eMoney licenses.

Cost: Low: Relies on existing system licenses and Karen's 8 weekly implementation hours.

Risk: Low: Controlled by a mandatory three-step sign-off checklist verified by the advisor before client delivery.

Time to benefit: Weeks: Pilot testing and initial time savings measured weekly by Karen within 90 days.

30-Day Action Plan

1. Michael Bennett and Rachel Torres draft and finalize the firm's written AI-use policy, approved-tool list, and usage log framework, specifically approving Microsoft Copilot for internal drafting and verifying Zoom AI Companion archiving through Smarsh. 2. Karen Doyle configures the prospect pipeline and automated three-day follow-up task rules in Wealthbox, establishing associate assignment and advisor approval workflows for the 30% of discovery meetings that go cold. 3. Karen Doyle tests pre-built review packet templates in Orion and eMoney planning summaries within existing licenses, and establishes the advisor verification checklist for review meeting preparation. 4. Karen Doyle sets up the onboarding pipeline in Wealthbox with stage tracking and weekly 7-day stale file reporting to chase missing documents and ACATS transfers.

Risks & Metrics

- Rachel Torres's exact compliance review timeline for approving internal tools and pre-population methods (estimated at weeks rather than days).

- Whether Orion and eMoney feature sets required for single-pull review packets and planning snapshots are fully included in existing license tiers or require add-on costs.
- Whether Zoom AI Companion meeting summaries are currently archiving correctly through Smarsh.
- Not investigated in this interview: Detailed architectural integration capabilities or API availability across Wealthbox, Orion, Schwab, and eMoney beyond manual re-entry and CSV/report constraints.
- Not investigated in this interview: Specific advisor compensation structures and incentive alignment.
- Not investigated in this interview: Detailed business continuity and disaster recovery test protocols beyond staff tenure.
- The automated figures cross-check did not complete. Owner-stated figures in this report remain attributed to the interview; independently verify calculated or modelled opportunity estimates and their assumptions against business records before relying on them.
- Prospect follow-up response time within one business day for 95% of inquiries (measured weekly by Karen Doyle).
- Median onboarding duration dropping from 3 to 5 weeks down to under 3 weeks (measured weekly by Karen Doyle).
- Review meeting preparation time dropping from 2.5 hours to under 1.5 hours per meeting (measured weekly by Karen Doyle from Wealthbox and Orion reports).
- Routine inbound inquiries answered with human-approved drafted responses.
- Written AI-use policy, approved-tool list, and usage log actually in place within 90 days.
- Weekly count of overdue onboarding pipeline files (not moved in 7 days) chased by Karen Doyle.